

Putting words together

For speech to make sense, words must be linked to other words in the right way to form sentences. Imagine a sports team—each player representing one word. A lone player cannot achieve very much, but, teamed with other players and following strict rules, he can achieve a lot. These rules of play are like grammar—they determine both direction and purpose.



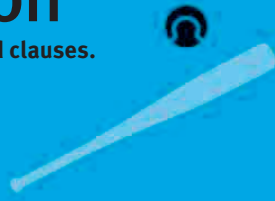
Conjunction

A word used to link words and clauses.

EXAMPLES

and, but, so, yet, or,
neither, nor, because

bat and ball



Interjection

A word that usually occurs alone and expresses emotion.

EXAMPLES

oh, hello, ah, ouch, phew,
yuck, hooray, help, er, um, oops



Article

A word used with a noun to refer to a specific person or thing, or someone or something in general.

EXAMPLES

a, an, the

the ball



Determiner

A word used in front of a noun to denote something specific or something of a particular type. Articles are also determiners.

EXAMPLES

those, many, my, his, few,
several, much, many my ball



Summary sentence

article → noun → adverb → verb → determiner → adjective → noun → preposition → interjection

The boy quickly kicked his bouncy ball past a defender, but in his haste he stumbled. oops!

↑ article ↑ noun ↑ conjunction ↑ preposition ↑ determiner ↑ noun ↑ pronoun ↑ verb